



EngC1001 Spring 26

Anti-Fast Fashion Movement

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Propaganda

a consistent, enduring effort to create or shape events to influence the relations of the public to an enterprise, idea or group (Bernays 25)

Anti–Fast Fashion messages can appear as a propaganda when they emphasize emotional appeals, rely on simplified generalizations, or align closely with the commercial interests of luxury brands.



Background

The Anti-Fast Fashion movement started in the 1970s with hippies (4tify). Its original mission was to challenge mass consumerism as well as to promote thrifting for the working class.

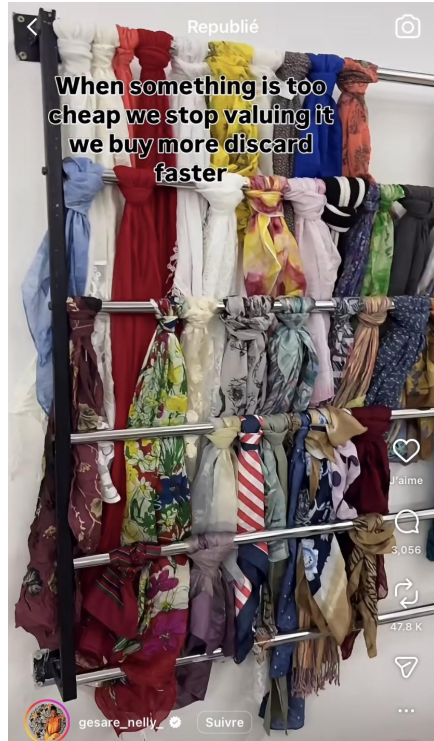
Despite such oppositions, fast fashion brands continue to grow in the following decades due to their cheap price offers.

Four Examples of Anti-Fast Fashion Messaging

- 1 Social Media Reels
- 2 Pop Culture Memes
- 3 Protest Signs
- 4 Website Content



Example 1: Fashion Wasteland in Kenya



Text: "When something is too cheap, we stop valuing it. We buy more [and] discard faster."

This short video on Instagram is posted by Nelly Gesare, a sustainability educator based in Kenya. Their full video can be found in the QR code below.



These wastelands are reportedly caused by clothing donations

Example 1 cont.

This is a **propaganda** because the creator has uploaded similar videos as a continuous effort to reduce clothing donation. It is not merely to inform but to influence against it

The audience of this video is being pushed to assume that their donated clothes would end up at a wasteland like this instead of being useful for someone else.

This is a **hasty generalization** because it is drawing a broad conclusion from a couple examples of dumpsites in Kenya. It makes it seem as if all fast fashion is equally responsible or all consumers contribute significantly to this textile waste.

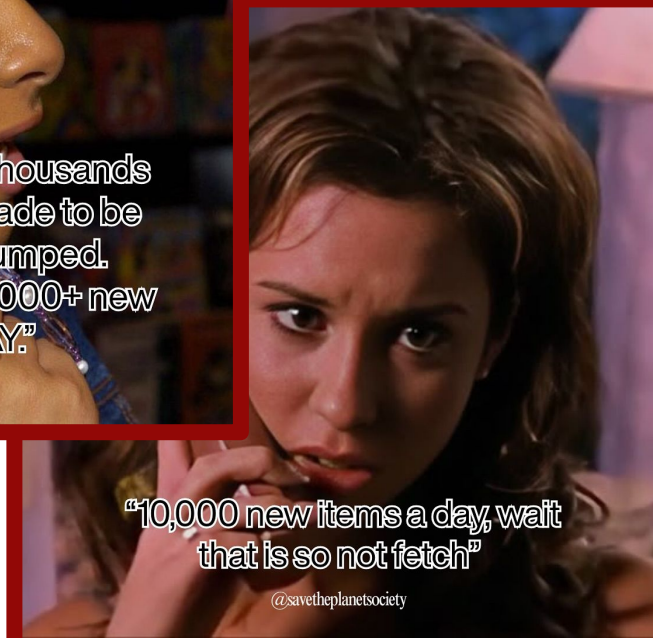
Moreover, it is also relying on **emotion appeal** by capturing the unfortunate conditions of Kenya wastelands to evoke guilt for purchasing cheap fashion products. This is a redirection of emotion to react instead of properly evaluating the cause. Hence, it could be considered **emotionally manipulative**.

Example 2: Gossip Girls



These memes leave a lasting impression of its message by associating popular characters with it

This is a propaganda because it frames fast fashion negatively and promote behavioral change.



Example 2 cont.

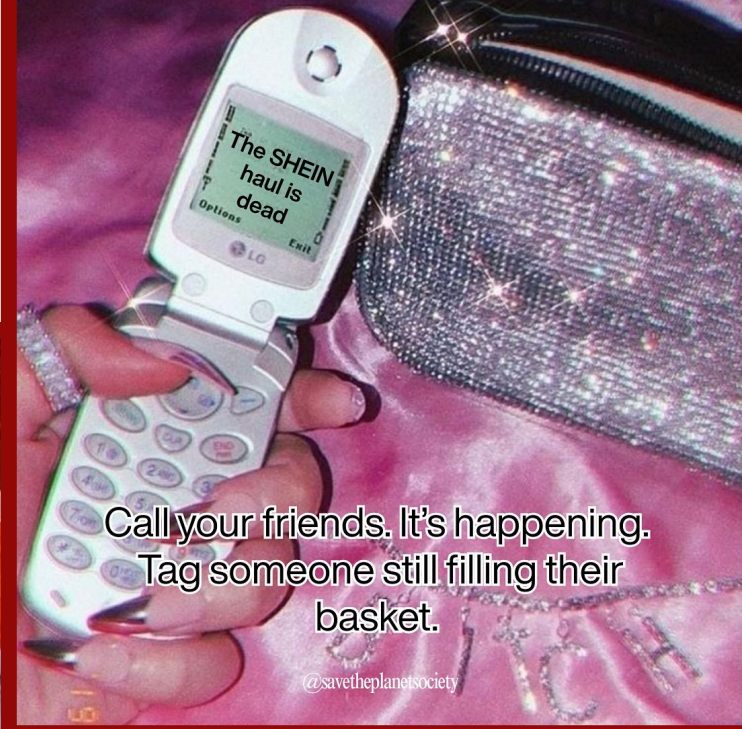
“Call your friends. It’s happening. Tag someone still filling their baskets”

This is a **bandwagon appeal** because it implies that the movement is gaining momentum and that “everyone is joining us, so you (and your friends) should too”.



“It’s not just Shein. The law targets brands that meet the ultra-fast fashion definition. Shein and Temu just top the list because of volume and speed.”

@savetheplanetsociety



*Call your friends. It’s happening.
Tag someone still filling their basket.*

@savetheplanetsociety

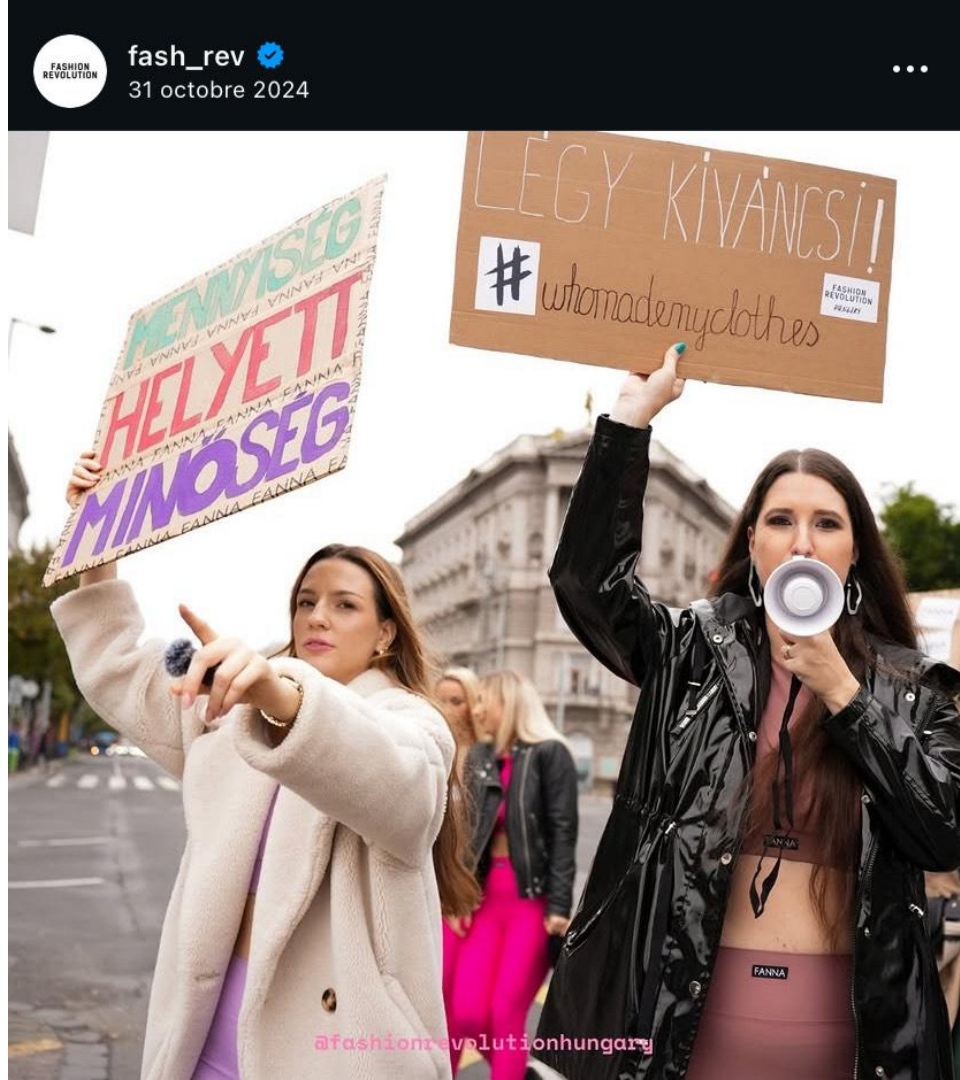
Relatable content can be **persuasive** as users feel connected to the message

Example 3: Protests in Europe

This is a propaganda because it is part of a consistent effort of `fash_rev`, a nonprofit organization of fashion activism.

The purpose is to influence government policy by drawing public attention in environmental and labour concerns of the clothing they wear daily.

The protesters shown on the right collaborated with a sustainable brand for their outfits.



`fash_rev` 
31 octobre 2024



Example 3 cont.

Example 3 cont.



Example 4: Grassroots Organizations

The extract is from a blog of GrüneInitiative Verein, “a grassroots organization founded in the heart of Linz, Austria, with a passion for environmental sustainability”.

4. **Raising Awareness and Activism** Through social media campaigns and protests, young activists are pressuring big brands to adopt ethical practices. Movements like #WhoMadeMyClothes challenge companies to be more transparent about their supply chains.

How You Can Join the Movement

- Buy less and choose quality over quantity.
- Support ethical and sustainable brands.
- Thrift, swap, or upcycle instead of buying new.
- Spread awareness and demand accountability from fashion brands.



Example 4 cont.

This is a propaganda because the organization is not merely stating facts but also advocating for their goal.

The blogs offer a balanced academic tone and explore the alternatives and middle grounds to fast fashions. **No notable logical fallacies were found.**

The example is rather **persuasive** because it directly addresses the reader to take the first steps in the direction of fashion sustainability.



Ethical Evaluation

Based on provided definition, propaganda can be of pure or malicious intention. Ethical propaganda is when the goal of the movement has a net benefit to the society where the means are not justified by the end result.

My chosen movement uses propaganda ethically for the most part because its propaganda is usually persuasive rather than deceptive. Most examples rely on emotional appeals and selective imagery to encourage environmental awareness. The use of propaganda did not significantly impact the movement's credibility in delivering the core message of sustainable fashion.

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